12.8.1 Open information

Whether it is a public chain or a private chain, you can search the blockchain ledger with an account number to find all the transactions associated with this address, as shown in figure 12.6. You can also search by transaction hash, block number, and other filters. If you have an account number, you can try it for by yourself at the Etherscan for Ropsten site (https://ropsten.etherscan.io).

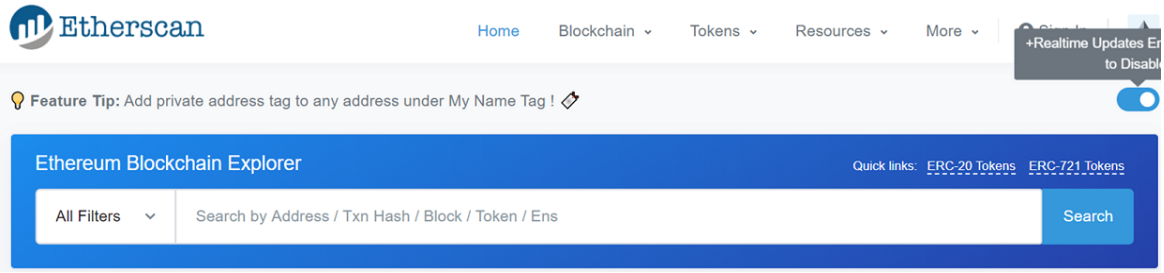


Figure 12.6 Searching the blockchain records by a certain filter

If I want to know all the transactions that originated from a certain identity, for example, I can search for it by using its account address, as shown in figure 12.7. You realize that you can secure all the data by using encryption, but the fact that the transaction happened is not confidential. It shows the transaction from account 0x28... along with other details. Even if the contents of transactions are encrypted, the transactions themselves are not confidential. If this is my address, you know that I have been frequently invoking a smart contract at the address 0x1e... This information conveys some intelligence to you. If the smart contract were my stockbroker, you might infer that I have been considering some financial moves. In other words, although my transactions were secure, they were not confidential.